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Feminine Gender: 6 Categories

There are 6 categories of Feminine Gender in Arabic:

1. **BIOLOGICALLY FEMININE.** This refers to words that are **Feminine by Nature**.

   Example:

Sister	أُخْتٌ
Mother	أُمٌّ
Cow	بَقَرَةٌ

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Feminine Gender: 6 Categories (Cont.)

There are 6 categories of Feminine Gender in Arabic:

2. **WORDS THAT END IN ة or اء or ى** : When a word has THREE LETTERS and those three letters are followed by ة or اء or ى the word is considered feminine.

   Example:

The big one	الكُبرَى
Mercy	رَحْمَةٌ
Black	سَوْدَاءُ
Prayer	صَلَاةٌ

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Feminine Gender: 6 Categories (Cont.)

3. **BODY PARTS IN PAIRS:** Body parts that come in pairs are feminine, both in the dual and singular forms.

lip	شَفَةٌ	ear	أُذُنٌ	hand	يَدٌ
foot	قَدَمٌ	leg	رِجْلٌ	eye	عَيْنٌ
shin	سَاقٌ	cheek	خَدٌّ	elbow	مِرْفَقٌ
ankle	كَعْبٌ	heel	عَقِبٌ	shoulder	مَنْكِبٌ

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Number العدد

All words in Arabic have :

- A **singular** version مُفْرَدٌ
- A **pair** version مُثَنًّى and
- A **plural** version جَمْعٌ

The singular and pair are standard and easy to recognize. They are the first and second columns of the مسلم chart. When it comes to plurals, however, there are four types. It needs to be discussed.



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Number العدد: 4 types of Plural

1. The sound masculine plural
2. The sound feminine plural
3. **The broken plural** جَمْعُ تَكْسِيرٍ
4. The plural by meaning



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The sound masculine plural

- The sound masculine plural refers to the **third column** in the masculine version of the مسلم chart.

Plural	Duel/Pair	Singular	Status
مُسْلِمُونَ 3R	مُسْلِمَانِ 2R	مُسْلِمٌ 1R	⟵ رَفْع
مُسْلِمِينَ 3N	مُسْلِمَيْنِ 2N	مُسْلِمًا 1N	⟵ نَصْب
مُسْلِمِينَ 3J	مُسْلِمَيْنِ 2J	مُسْلِمٍ 1J	⟵ جَرّ

Table 1: **Sound Masculine Plural** of the Muslimun Table



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Broken Plural

- Broken plurals are plurals in which there is **no specific pattern** for *singular* ⟶ *plural* transition. In order words the original word (i.e. singular) is broken when you get the plural form.
- **Example in English:** In regular words: cat->cats
  but for broken plural goose->geese, child->children, mouse->mice
- **Example in Arabic:** This Singular⟶Plural is **wrong** مَسْخِد ⟶ مَسْخِدُونَ.
  The **correct form** is مَسْخِد ⟶مَسَاخِد
- Because broken plurals do not have an ending combination that indicates that they are plural, they tend to **look like singular**. The only way to differentiate between them is to **memorize** them.
- Broken Plural in Arabic plays an important role in grammar.



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Broken Plural: Example

Below are some common broken plural patterns that appear in the Quran.

المعنى	جمع	مفرد	المعنى	جمع	مفرد
one of a pair	أَزْوَاجٌ	زَوْجٌ	witness	شُهَداءُ	شاهِدٌ
emotional heart	أَفْئِدَةٌ	فُؤَادٌ	blessing	نِعَمٌ	نِعْمَةٌ
woman	نِساءٌ	اِمْرَأَةٌ	prophet	أَنْبِياءُ	نَبِيٌّ

Figure 1: Broken Plurals

[1] Image NAK Textbook page 39



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Plural by Meaning

- There are words that appear to be singular but are considered plural **because** they have a plural meaning in that they refer to a group comprised of many members. (In English we have "collective nouns")
- **Examples:**

المعنى (Meaning)	الكلمة (Word)
a nation	قَومٌ
an argumentative group	خَصمٌ
people	نَاسٌ
generation	قَرنٌ

المعنى (Meaning)	الكلمة (Word)
an army	جُنْدٌ
family	آلٌ
family	أَهْلٌ



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Drill 7 Answer Key Explanation

1. العُلَمَاءُ Broken Plural, Human. So, as it is.
2. الجِبَالِ Broken Plural, Non-Human. So it is Feminine Singular. ✓
3. أَنْهارًا Broken Plural, Non-Human. So, it is Feminine Singular. ✓
4. أَنْبِيَاءُ Broken Plural, Human. So, as it is.
5. قَاعِلٌ Regular Singular
6. مُفْسِدِينَ Regular Plural: Ref. مُسلِمٌ Chart Table 4, Part 1.
7. السَّفِينَةِ Feminine, ending letter
8. آيَاتٍ Regular Feminine Plural: Ref. مُسلِمَةٌ Chart Table 5, Part 1
9. يَدٌ Feminine, body part in pair
10. عَابِدَاتٌ Regular Feminine Plural: Ref. مُسلِمَةٌ Chart Table 5, Part 1



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Pointers[1]

Pointers can point **near or far** objects.

FOR POINTING NEAR

PLURAL	PAIR	SINGULAR	
هَؤُلاءِ	هَذانِ	هَذا	masc.
these	Both of these	this	
هَؤُلاءِ	هَتانِ	هَذِهِ	fem.
these	Both of these	This	

Figure 4: Near Pointers

[1]Dream Text Book, page no.34



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Pointers (Cont.)

Pointers can point **near or far** objects.

FOR POINTING FAR

PLURAL	PAIR	SINGULAR	
أُوْلايِكَ	ذَيْنِكَ	ذٰلِكَ	masc.
those	Both of those	That	
أُوْلايِكَ	تَيْنِكَ	تِلْكَ	fem.
those	Both of those	That	

Figure 5: Far Pointers



Exercise: Proper and Common Noun[1]

- Indicate whether the following words are Common or Proper, and give the reason why:

Reason	Type	Word	Reason	Type	Word
	P / C	1. مُخْرِجِيَ الكافِرِيْنَ		P / C	2. طَائِفَتَيْنِ
	P / C	3. جَنَّةٌ		P / C	4. نُوْحًا
	P / C	5. يا أُسْتَاذُ		P / C	6. القَالِيْنَ
	P / C	7. مُسْتَفْتِ		P / C	8. طَائِرُكُمْ
	P / C	9. هؤلاء		P / C	10. الَّتِيْ

Figure 6: Proper or Common Noun

[1]Dream Work Book Page No.24,27

Exercise: Proper and Common Noun Answer Key

- Indicate whether the following words are Common or Proper, and give the reason why:

Reason	Type	Word	Reason	Type	Word
after-of is proper	**P** / C	1. مُخْرِجِيَ الكافِرِيْنَ	default	P / **C**	2. طَائِفَتَيْنِ
default	P / **C**	3. جَنَّةٌ	proper name	**P** / C	4. نُوْحًا
one being called (منادى)	**P** / C	5. يا أُسْتَاذُ	ال	**P** / C	6. القَالِيْنَ
default	P / **C**	7. مُسْتَفْتِ	after-of is proper	**P** / C	8. طَائِرُكُمْ
اسم الإشارة	**P** / C	9. هَؤُلاءِ	اسم موصول	**P** / C	10. الَّتِيْ

Figure 7: Proper or Common Noun

Special Note on: كُلٌّ

- Note that the meaning of كُلٌّ changes depending on the number and type of the مُضَاف إليه (i.e. Next word) (Rule iv). Below are the possible scenarios:

  i If the مُضَاف إليه is SINGULAR AND COMMON, the meaning is each and every
  Example: كُلُّ مَسجِدٍ each and every masjid.

  ii If the مُضَاف إليه is SINGULAR AND PROPER, the meaning is the entire
  Example: كُلُّ المَسجِدِ the entire masjid.

  iii If the مُضَاف إليه is PLURAL AND PROPER , the meaning is all of
  Example: كُلُّ المَسَاجِدِ all of the masjids.

Fragments: المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة

- It is basically a pair of words: Noun+Adjective. In English we say "A big car" while in Arabic we say "A car big". So, in Arabic, first Noun then Adjective.
- Example: الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ The path(noun) straight(adj.)
- The first one (here الصِّرَاطَ) is an ordinary إسم called مَوْصُوف while second one (here الْمُسْتَقِيمَ) is the description or Adjective called صِفَة



Mawsoof and Sifa المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة

- Sifa/Adjective ← Mowsoof/Noun
- Example: الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ The path(noun) straight(adj.) Here الصِّرَاطَ is the مَوْصُوف and الْمُسْتَقِيمَ is the صِفَة
- One مَوْصُوف may have multiple صِفَة
  Sifa3 , Sifa2 , Sifa1 ← Mowsoof
- Both مَوْصُوف and صِفَة have exactly same 4 properties (i.e. Status/Number/Gender/Type) in short we call them (S/N/G/T)



Mawsoof and Sifa المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة Example Explained

- Both مَوْصُوف and صِفَة have exactly same 4 properties (i.e. Status/Number/Gender/Type)
- Example 1: مَسْجِدًا كَبِيرًا← A masjid big. ← A big masjid Both are N/1/M/C (i.e. Nasb, Singular, Masculine and Common)
  Some valid combinations:
  ✓ مَسْجِدٍ كَبِيرٍ ✓ مَسْجِدٌ كَبِيرٌ
  Some invalid combinations:
  مَسْجِدٍ كَبِيرٌ مَسْجِدٍ كَبِيرًا مَسْجِدٌ كَبِيرًا
- Example 2: مَسْجِدَانِ كَبِيرَانِ ← Two masjids big ← Two big masjids Both are R/2/M/C (i.e. Rafa, Duel, Masculine and Common)



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Ism: Number Number Type Fragments: Al Mawsoof and Sifah المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة Fragments by Pointers

Sura Fatiha: Apply

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ ۝٢ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ ۝٣ مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ ۝٤

i. لِلَّهِ

- For Allah (swt). اللَّهِ لِ Here, لِ is a Harf of Jarr, so, the next word must be a Jarr, so it is اللَّهِ (e sound at the end.)
4 properties of the word اللَّهِ: it is J/1/M/P (Jarr, Singular, Masculine and Proper)

- Now the next observation is if it is a مَوْصُوف To verify it it is needed to find the next word or segment (group of words) must have exactly the same 4 properties of the word اللَّهِ i.e. J/1/M/P Then we the next word or segment will be a صِفَة.

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Ism: Number Number Type Fragments: Al Mawsoof and Sifah المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة Fragments by Pointers

Sura Fatiha: Apply (Cont.1)

ii. رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

- Recall the conditions of a مُضَاف i) Light and ii) No ال. Condition of a مُضَاف إليه i) It must be Jarr. Here رَبِّ is Light and has no ال and الْعَالَمِينَ is Jarr. Thats why the meaning is "Lord OF the worlds".
- 4P of رَبِّ are J/1/M/P(?). Because, its مُضَاف إليه i.e. الْعَالَمِينَ is Proper. (Recall مُضَاف inherits its Type from its مُضَاف إليه) 4 P of الْعَالَمِينَ are J/3/M/P

Remember: مُضَاف and مُضَاف إليه is inseparable so treated as a single unit. Then what is the 4P of this unit?

Ans: 4P of the world رَبِّ i.e. J/1/M/P since رَبِّ is the main word of this phrase.

Note: This unit رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ and the main word اللَّهِ both have the same 4P i.e. J/1/M/P. That means the next unit is a صِفَة (Sifa No.1)

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Ism: Number Number Type Fragments: Al Mawsoof and Sifah المَوْصُوف وَ الصِفَة Fragments by Pointers

Sura Fatiha: Apply (Cont.2)

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ ۝٢ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ ۝٣ مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ ۝٤

iii. الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

- 4P of الرَّحْمَٰنِ are J/1/M/P. It exactly matches the 4P of the main (مَوْصُوف) word اللَّهِ. So, it is another صِفَة (Sifa No. 2)

- 4P of الرَّحِيمِ are J/1/M/P. It exactly matches the 4P of the main (مَوْصُوف) word اللَّهِ. So, it is another صِفَة (Sifa No. 3)

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Properties of Pointers

i. Pointers are always Proper. Example: ذَٰلِكَ ٱلْكِتَـٰبُ i.e. This book, it indicates a particular book so it is Proper.

ii. They are non-flexible. Example:
إِنَّ ذَالِكَ
مِن ذَالِكَ
Note: Here, the pointer ذَالِكَ does not change because of the Harf of Nasb or Harf of Jarr. In the first case the word ذَالِكَ is مَنْصُوبٌ while the second one is مَجْرُورٌ.
So the status of pointers must be deduced from the context not from its ending sound.

iii. Pointers can be used to make either Sentence or Fragment.
Rule: If the pointer is followed by definite article AL ال then it is a Fragment otherwise it is a sentence. No ال make it a sentence.

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Properties of Pointers (Cont.)

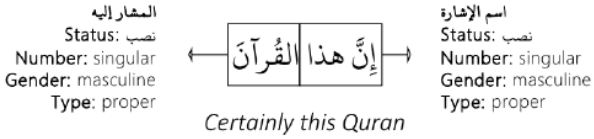
iii. Pointers can be used to make either Sentence or Fragment.
Rule: If the pointer is followed by definite article AL ال then it is a Fragment otherwise it is a sentence. No ال makes it a sentence.
Examples:

- ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ That book (i.e. Fragment)
  ذَٰلِكَ كِتَابٌ That is a book (i.e. Sentence)
- هَذَا بَيَانٌ لِلنَّاسِ This is a clarification for human. (i.e. Sentence)
  هَذَا البَيَانُ لِلنَّاسِ This clarification for human. (i.e. Fragment)
- هَؤُلَاءِ كَافِرُونَ These are disbelievers. (i.e. Sentence)
  هَؤُلَاءِ الكَافِرُونَ These disbelievers. (i.e. Fragment)

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Properties of Pointers (Cont.2)

iv. Both إِسْمُ الإِشَارَة (i.e Pointer) and المُشَارُ إِلَيهِ (i.e. object being pointed) must match 4 properties (S/N/G/T).
Examples:



Certainly this Quran

[1] Here the pointer fails to show its Nasab Status

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- Balagah: page: 433



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Test of shortcut key

وَ جَآءَتْ سَكْرَةُ ٱلْمَوْتِ بِـٱلْحَقِّ



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